MARKET BRIEF · SAMPLE

CGM Market Brief.

Two firms, one opening.

Sample deliverable · **June 2026**

ZKK Consulting LLC
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Market Brief
Deliverable tier

CONTEXT

Who leads U.S. continuous glucose monitoring, how access is shifting to over-the-counter, and where an entrant should look first. A work sample built from public sources.

IN THIS REPORT

01	Market and competition	Size, growth drivers, and the four players that matter.
02	Regulatory snapshot	The iCGM pathway and OTC clearances since 2024.
03	Opportunity and risk	Three opportunities, three risks, and what they mean.
	Bottom line	Head-on competition with Abbott and Dexcom is the hardest path. Viable wedges are a niche, an OTC consumer brand, or a software layer. Figures are public estimates.

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SAMPLE

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1. Market at a glance

A large, fast-growing category, in the middle of a structural shift from prescription-only to consumer access.

Continuous glucose monitoring has moved from a niche tool for insulin-dependent diabetes to one of the fastest-growing categories in medical devices. Grand View Research estimates the global CGM market at roughly $15.8 billion in 2025, up from about $13.7 billion in 2024, and projects it to reach nearly $50 billion by 2033 at a low-teens-to-mid-teens CAGR. North America alone accounts for an estimated 56.8% of global revenue. Estimates vary meaningfully by firm and segmentation, but every major source points the same direction: sustained double-digit growth.

~$15.8B	~15%	~92%	4
GLOBAL CGM MARKET, 2025	PROJECTED CAGR TO 2033	REVENUE HELD BY TOP 2 FIRMS	OTC CLEARANCES SINCE 2024

1.1 What is driving growth

- **Type 2 expansion.** Adoption is spreading well beyond Type 1 and insulin-using patients into the much larger non-insulin Type 2 population.
- **Over-the-counter access.** The first FDA-cleared OTC sensors (2024) opened a cash-pay wellness and metabolic-health buyer base that did not exist before.
- **Broader reimbursement.** Medicare's 2023 coverage expansion extended CGM eligibility to non-insulin patients with a history of problematic hypoglycemia: an estimated 1.5 million additional beneficiaries.

2. Competitive snapshot

Two firms dominate revenue. Two more hold defensible niches.

The category is effectively a duopoly: Abbott and Dexcom together control roughly 92% of CGM revenue (Abbott ~57%, Dexcom ~35% of 2024 revenue per Grand View Research), with Medtronic at ~7% and Senseonics holding a small but distinct implantable position.

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Table 1. Flagship CGM systems and what sets them apart

Company	Flagship product(s)	Wear time	Key differentiator
Dexcom	G7 & G7 15-Day (Rx); Stelo (OTC)	10.5 to 15.5 days	Best published accuracy (G7 MARD ~8.2%), 30-min warm-up; Stelo is the first OTC sensor for non-insulin adults
Abbott	FreeStyle Libre 3 Plus (Rx); Lingo & Libre Rio (OTC)	up to 14 to 15 days	Revenue and volume leader; lowest-cost scale; broadest OTC lineup (wellness + non-insulin T2D)
Medtronic	Guardian 4 / Simplera	~7 days	Tightly integrated with Medtronic's MiniMed automated insulin delivery ecosystem
Senseonics	Eversense 365	365 days (implantable)	Only implantable CGM; year-long sensor with in-office insertion, for Type 1 and Type 2

Source: manufacturer-published and FDA-cleared figures as of mid-2026. MARD = Mean Absolute Relative Difference, the standard accuracy measure; lower is better.

3. Regulatory snapshot

A maturing pathway, and a recent opening toward consumer access.

CGMs are regulated by the FDA as Class II devices. The integrated CGM (iCGM) category was established through a De Novo authorization (Dexcom G6, 2018) with special controls, which now lets subsequent sensors clear via the 510(k) pathway against iCGM predicates rather than starting from scratch: a meaningful accelerant for credible entrants. The defining recent development is the wave of over-the-counter clearances:

- **Dexcom Stelo:** first OTC CGM cleared (March 2024; launched August 2024, ~$89 for a two-sensor pack), for adults not using insulin.
- **Abbott Lingo & Libre Rio:** cleared June 2024; Lingo as a general wellness tool, Libre Rio for non-insulin Type 2 diabetes.
- **Senseonics Eversense 365:** cleared September 2024 as the first one-year implantable sensor.

WHAT THIS SIGNALS

Regulators have now validated a non-prescription, non-insulin "metabolic health" use case. That expands the addressable buyer pool far beyond insulin-dependent diabetes and changes the competitive question from "who has the best clinical sensor" to "who owns the consumer relationship."

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4. Where the opportunity is

And where the hard parts are.

Three opportunities

- **OTC / cash-pay wellness.** Now FDA-sanctioned and largely greenfield beyond insulin users.
- **Non-insulin Type 2.** A large, under-penetrated, increasingly reimbursed population thanks to the 2023 Medicare expansion.
- **Software & integration.** Coaching, data, and AID integration layers offer room to differentiate above a commoditizing sensor.

Three risks

- **Duopoly scale.** Abbott + Dexcom hold ~92% of revenue; their cost, distribution, and payer relationships are hard to match.
- **Price compression.** OTC is pushing per-sensor pricing down (Stelo ≈ $45/sensor), squeezing margins.
- **Regulatory & accuracy bar.** iCGM special controls and MARD expectations raise the cost and time to a credible product.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR A MARKET ENTRANT

Competing head-on with the duopoly on a general-purpose prescription sensor is the hardest possible path. The viable wedges are differentiation, not imitation: a defensible niche (a specific population, or a distinct form factor such as implantable, extended-wear, or non-invasive), an OTC / cash-pay consumer brand and experience, or a software and coaching layer that rides on existing sensors. Partnering into an incumbent's ecosystem may de-risk entry faster than competing against it.

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Appendix A. Selected sources

Grand View Research, Continuous Glucose Monitoring Devices Market Report. GlobalMarketInsights, U.S. CGM Market. U.S. FDA device clearance announcements (Stelo, Lingo, Libre Rio, Eversense 365). CMS / Medicare 2023 CGM coverage update. Manufacturer product specifications (Dexcom, Abbott, Medtronic, Senseonics).

Market-size figures vary by research firm and segmentation; ranges are presented with attribution. Figures current as of June 2026.

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